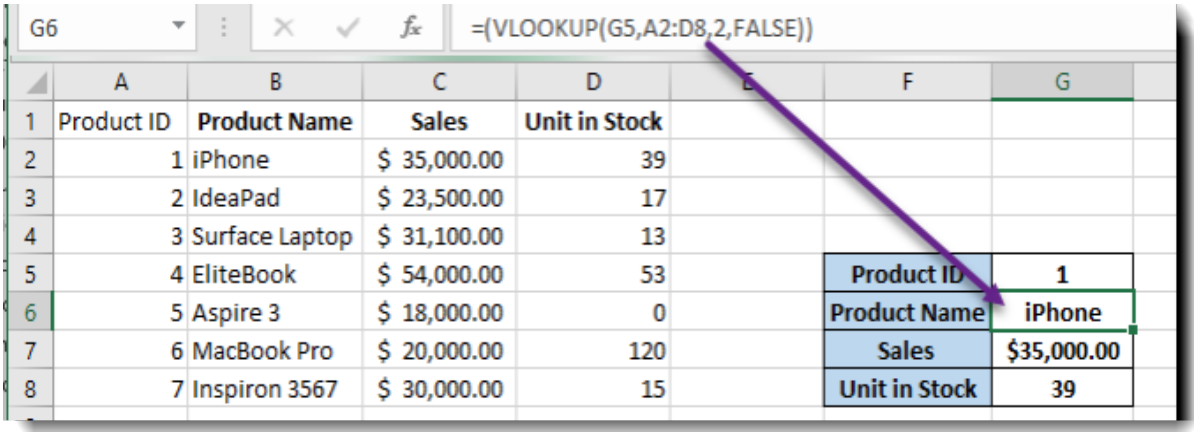
INDEX MATCH FUNCTION

The INDEX and MATCH function in Excel is a smart way of doing two-way lookups. It is an alternative you can use to overcome the limitations of VLOOKUP function. The INDEX and MATCH function provides you with an extensive flexibility once you have gotten a good understanding of how it works.

The illustration below better explains the limitation of VLookup function and why you should consider using the INDEX and MATCH function.



	A	B	C	D	F	G
1	Product ID	Product Name	Sales	Unit in Stock		
2	1	iPhone	$ 35,000.00	39		
3	2	IdeaPad	$ 23,500.00	17		
4	3	Surface Laptop	$ 31,100.00	13		
5	4	EliteBook	$ 54,000.00	53	Product ID	1
6	5	Aspire 3	$ 18,000.00	0	Product Name	iPhone
7	6	MacBook Pro	$ 20,000.00	120	Sales	$35,000.00
8	7	Inspiron 3567	$ 30,000.00	15	Unit in Stock	39

The cells range **F5**:**G8** serves as a simple information-gathering system that collects data from the cell range **A2**:**D8** using the VLOOKUP command.

The **Product ID**, entered manually in cell **G5**, is used by the VLOOKUP formula to find the desired values. The final argument (FALSE) ensures an exact match between the **Product ID** and the first column of the source data.

Constraints of VLOOKUP

- **VLOOKUP has a restriction where the search value must always be located in the first column of the reference array.** The value located to the left of the search value in the data source cannot be retrieved. This can be a significant issue when working with data you are not allowed to altered or rearranged. From the above illustration, if you are expected to enter the